

Infusco/Accendo

for double bass with preparations

Neil Thornock

For Nathan Wood

Infusco/Accendo

for double bass with preparations

Commissioned by the
Barlow Endowment for Music Composition
at Brigham Young University

Neil Thornock

duration: ca. 32'

Program Note

to appear at all performances

Infusco/Accendo

Commissioned by the Barlow Endowment for Music Composition at Brigham Young University
Written for and dedicated to Nathan Wood

Infusco: to darken, corrupt

Accendo: to kindle, illuminate, make bright

I. Under the Sun

None shall be weary nor stumble among them;
none shall slumber nor sleep. (Isaiah 5:27)

II. Backslidden

Why then is this people. . . slidden back by a perpetual backsliding?
they hold fast to deceit, they refuse to return. (Jeremiah 8:5)

III. Earthgroans

Wo, wo is me, the mother of men;
I am pained, I am weary. (Moses 7:48)

IV. Lamentation

Let your laughter be turned to mourning,
and your joy to heaviness. (James 4:8)

V. Dark Ambulation

They have made them crooked paths. (Isaiah 59:8)

VI. Fire

The presence of the Lord shall be as the melting fire that burneth,
and as the fire which causeth the waters to boil. . .
And the saints who are upon the earth, who are alive,
shall be quickened and caught up to meet him. (Doctrine and Covenants 133:41; 88:96)

VII. Renascence

The whole earth is at rest,
and is quiet. (Isaiah 14:7)

for Nathan Wood

Infusco/Accendo

I. Under the Sun

Neil Thornock
Autumn 2004
Bloomington, IN

Motoric, crisp, relentless $\text{♩} = 138$
absolutely without rubato!

Double Bass

3 x

ppp

4

3 x

(ppp)
see performance note

7

3 x

10

2 x

mf

12

p *mf*

15

3 x II III I II

pp *mp* *pp*

18

2 x

mf *pp* *mf*

21

2 x

pp *(mf)*

Infusco/Accendo

23 ^{3 x}
pp *p* *mf*

27 ^{2 x} ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³
p *mf* *mp*

30 ^{3 x} ^{2 x}
mf *pp sub.*

34 ^{2 x}
(pp)

38 ^{2 x}
f

41 ^{2 x} ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³ ³
(f) *pp*

44 ^{2 x}
f

49 ^{3 x}
ff *mf* *mp*

Infusco/Accendo

54 2 x 3 x

mf *f*

58 3 x

61 savagely! brackets: use extremely heavy bow pressure

ff

65 3 x II I

f

70 3 x

ff

75 3 x 2 x

mf

79

ff

83

Infusco/Accendo

86

3 x

mf *mp* *mf* *mp*

2 x

90

ff

94

2 x

(*mf*) *p*

note the change in pattern

98

ff

101

driving!

extremely heavy bow, rather scratchy

105

2 x

fff

3

110

3

Infusco/Accendo

115

p

120

(*mf*)

124

pp *pp*

128

ppp

proceed to ending 1 or ending 2

ENDING 1 (see performance note)

131

fff

attacca mvt. 2
6'45"

ENDING 2 (see performance note)

137

n.
6'45"

II. Backslidden

"Dirty", with lots of grungy rubato

Musical score for "II. Backslidden" by Infusco/Accendo. The score is written in bass clef with various time signatures and dynamic markings. It includes performance instructions like "gliss.", "rit.", and "poco a poco sul tasto".

Measures 1-4: $\bullet = 116$, *p*, gliss.

Measures 5-8: *mp*

Measures 9-14: *p*, *pp*

Measures 15-19: *mf*, gliss.

Measures 20-24: *f*

Measures 25-29: *pp*, *mp*, gliss.*

Measures 30-34: *pp*, *p*, *ppp*, $\bullet = 72$, $\bullet = 52$, rit., sul tasto

*Downward glissando with whole-step trill, in the rhythm notated.

Infusco/Accendo

♩ = 116

35 ord. *f* gliss. gliss. gliss.

39 4 x gliss. 4 x *ff* = 138 savagely!

44 brackets: use extremely heavy bow pressure

48 rit. poco a poco sul tasto = 72 gliss. ord. pizz. arco rit. poco a poco sul tasto *f* *mp* *f* *p* *mp*

52 = 52 sul tasto = 116 pizz. rit. = 72 rit. sul tasto gliss. *pp* *mp* *p*

55 = 116 rit. = 52 sul tasto arco gliss. *mp* *ppp*

62 = 116 ord. 4 x 2 x gliss. *f*

Infusco/Accendo

Slower ♩ = 100
Dry, expressionless,
emotionally detached

67

p

71

74

pizz.

79

Same tempo ♩ = 100
arco

rit. ———— ♩ = 72

mf

83

♩ = 100

rit. ———— ♩ = 52

♩ = 72

rit. ————

arco

pizz.

mp

p

87

♩ = 52

pizz.

arco
cold, nonvibrato

gliss.

pp

ppp

3'45"

III. Earthgroans

Prepare with popsicle stick under string I, over II, under III, on second node.

All pizzicati played on open strings.

Everything else played on the E string.

~~~~~ Circular bowing, one rotation per note (see performance notes).

Slow, mournful ♩ = 60

~~~~~

ppp

9

p *ppp*

18

pizz. arco one rotation - - - -

pp *ppp*

24

pizz. tap the body forcefully with one fingertip

p *f*

31

arco

pp *ppp*

38

col legno battuto IV - - - -

ff *sfz*

Infusco/Accendo

43

→ sul pont. → ord. tap → sul pont.

ppp *f* *ppp*

51

pizz. arco IV

pp *mp*

58

pizz.

p

65

arco IV

mp

70

pizz.

pp

77

4 x 3 3 IV arco sul pont.

ppp

Remove popsicle stick

IV. Lamentation

♩ = 72

arco nonvibrato

III cantabile

simile

p pizz. + + +

7

13

19

25

32

2'00"

simile

Abruptly!

* Dampen the strings

Presto - funky ♩ = 138

3 x jazz-style pizz.

(crescendo in waves)

33

ff

37

mp *f*

41

mf

44

mp *p*

47

mp *p*

51

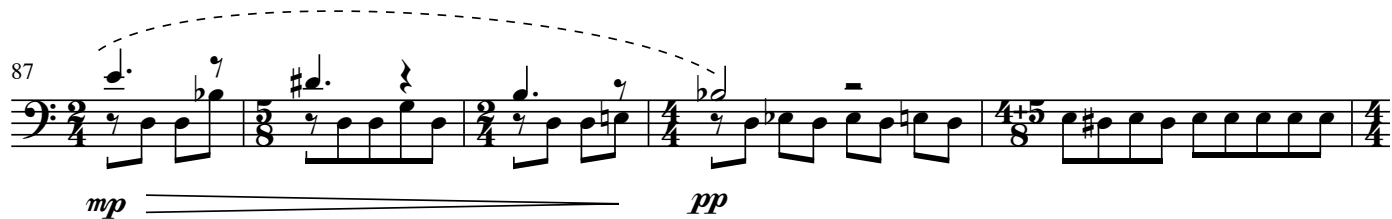
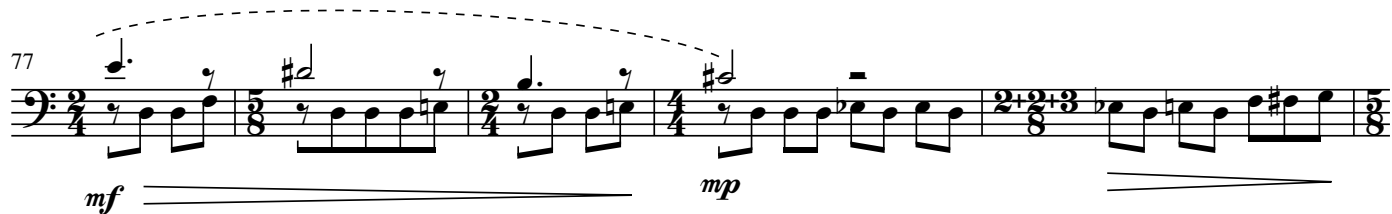
f

54

mp *p*

Infusco/Accendo

58 Slower ♩ = 120

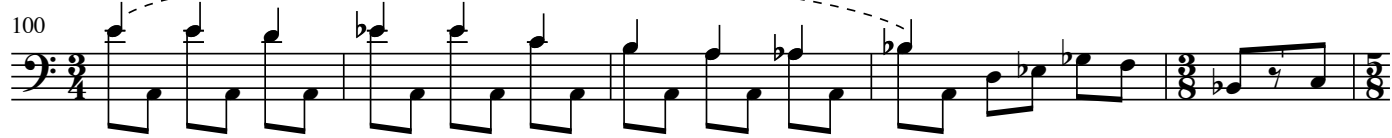


Infusco/Accendo

Slightly faster $\bullet = 126$



mp



pp



mf

p

mf

p



ff

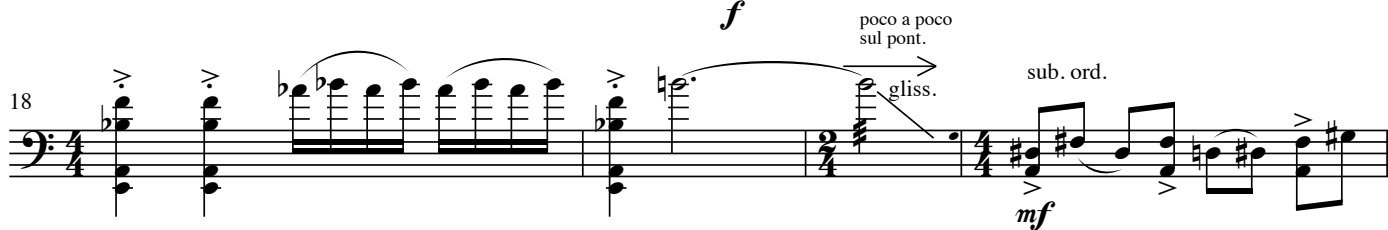
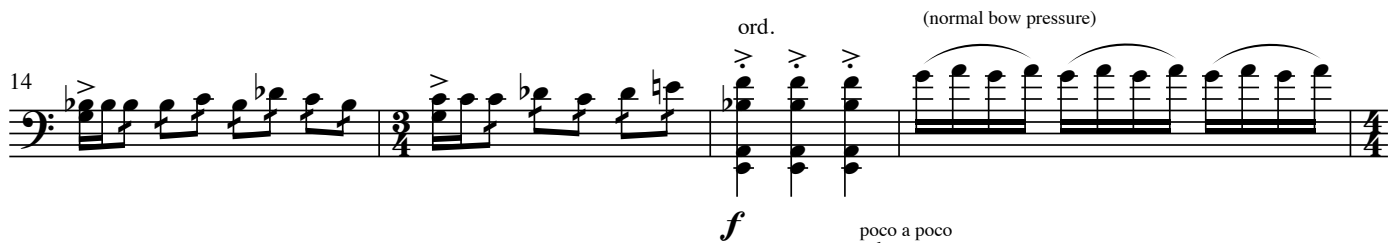
attacca

4'30"

VI. Fire

Presto con fuoco ♩ = 138
Driving, breathless, nonrubato
sul ponticello (poco throughout)

arco



sul ponticello



ord.

28



32



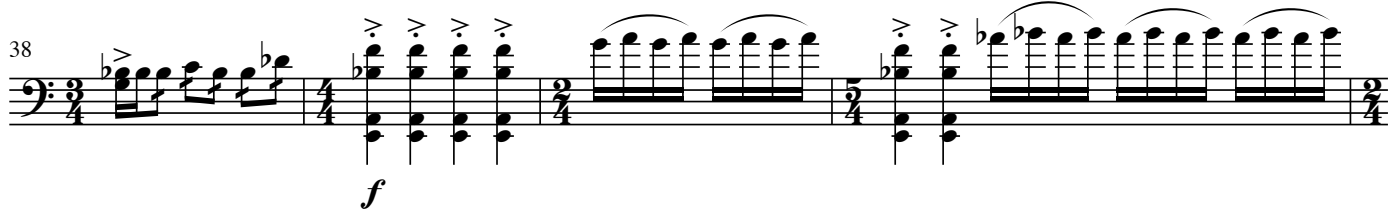
sul ponticello

35



ord.

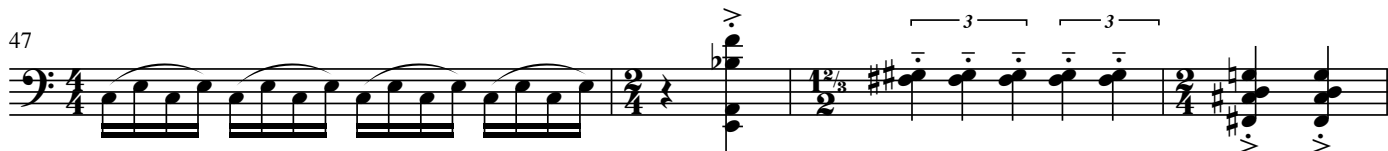
38



42



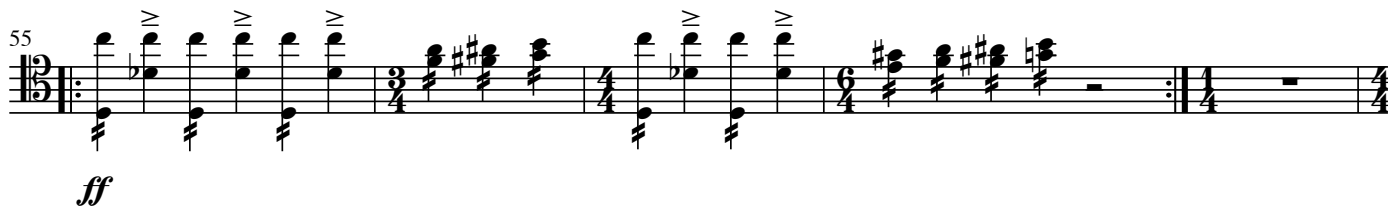
47



51



55



Infusco/Accendo

60

65

68

72

77

ord.

82

85

88

ff

fff

Infusco/Accendo

poco a poco
sul pont.

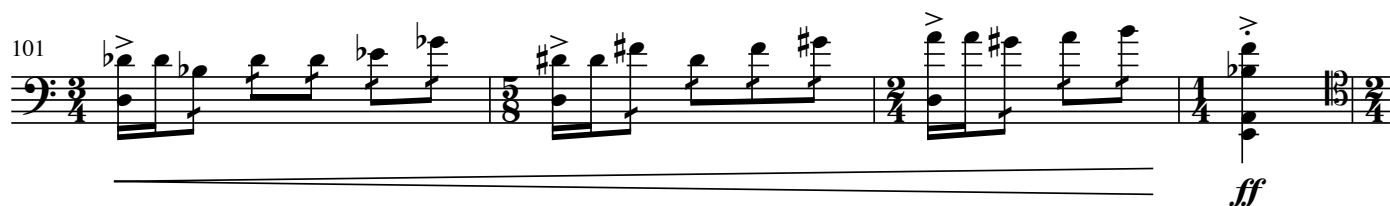
gliss.



sul ponticello



p



ff

ord.



Dramatically! ♩ = 52



fff

♩ = 138



4'30"

VII. Renaissance

Prepare with fabric around string III and tucked under IV.
Then tune the A string down to the E.

With profound calm and quietness ♩ = 52

III 20" II

ppp

sustain the E throughout;
change bow only as needed, as infrequently as possible
change bow as imperceptibly as possible

4

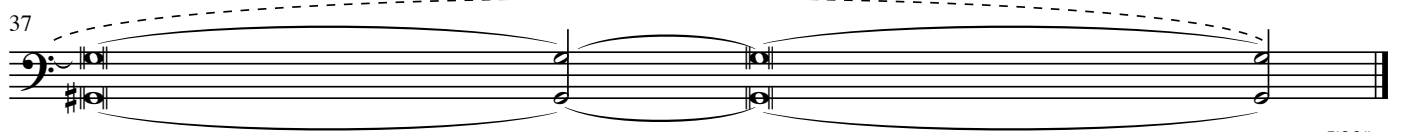
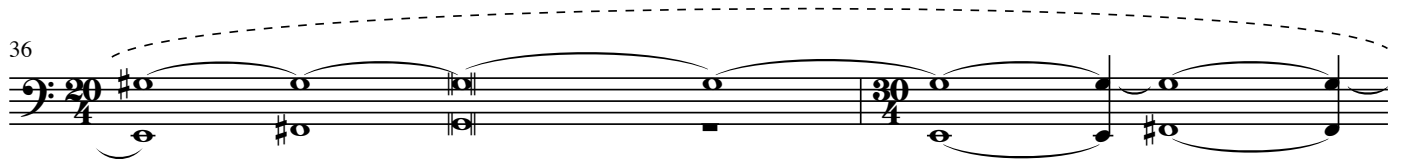
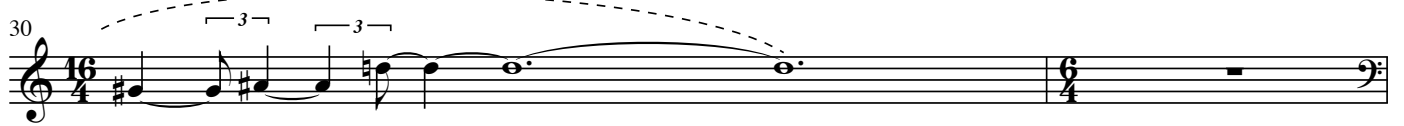
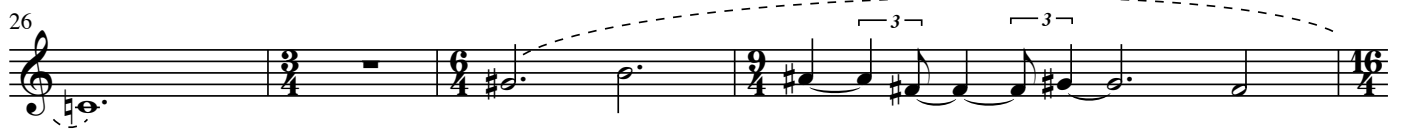
7

10

13

15

Infusco/Accendo



5'30"

Performance Notes

Amplification

The bass may be amplified to allow the quiet nature of some of the movements and effects to be heard. This is particularly desirable in large halls.

Preparations

Popsicle stick

Thick fabric (a cut-off athletic sock top works well)

III. *Earthgroans*: Prepare with popsicle stick under string I, over II, under III, on second node. A complex ring should result when the prepared notes are played pizzicato.

VII. *Renascence*: Prepare with fabric around string III and tucked under IV. This should dampen string III enough to let the melody be prominent.

Notes for individual movements

I. *Under the Sun*: Dynamics in parentheses apply only to the first statement of a loop. Indicated *crescendi* or *diminuendi* are thus continuous throughout all repetitions of the loop.

Dynamics not in parentheses apply to each statement of the loop. The initial dynamic level is thus resumed following a *crescendo* or *diminuendo*.

This movement has two endings. Ending 1 is to be used when the entire piece is performed. Ending 2 must be used when the movement is performed alone. Ending 2 may also be used when followed directly by a quiet movement.

III. *Earthgroans*: See *Preparations* above for notes on preparing the instrument.

Circular bowing is indicated as follows: ~~~~~

Move the bow in a large circular motion, always in contact with the string, taking the bow from *sul ponticello* to *sul tast* (see diagram). *Get the string to groan*. Keep the circular motion large even as the rhythm of the circle accelerates.

VII. *Renascence*: See *Preparations* above for notes on preparing the instrument.

Scordatura: *First secure the fabric in place.*

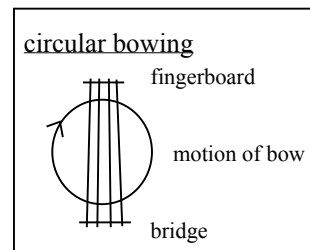
Then tune the A string to the low E.

The low E sounds throughout the entire movement, until the change at m. 36.

The melody is played on the D string.

Strive to bring out the melody over the drone (this may require experimentation with the fabric).

Bow changes should be as infrequent and as imperceptible as possible.



Additional notes

Various multimovement subsets are possible for an abbreviated performance.

Movements I and III may be performed as separate pieces.

Movements II, IV, V, VI, and VII must be performed as part of a multimovement set

When the piece is performed in its entirety, the original ordering of movements is to be maintained.

Please notify the composer of all performances:

neil_thornock@yahoo.com